

THE PROBLEM LENA DESCRIBED

# Fill the gap. Keep one clear promise.

Last-minute cancellations create empty appointments and repeated checking.

## Today

Staff check Square, scan a Google Sheet, text a likely match, and wait. The stopping point is unclear.

## The failure to avoid

Two clients once said yes to the same group text. Different staff replied, and a client arrived expecting the slot.

## Lena's goal

Fewer empty slots, less chasing, and one visible appointment holder. Square remains the real calendar.

Agreed approach: oldest eligible request first, one client at a time for each opening.

HOW THE PROTOTYPE BEHAVES

# Offer. Wait. Resolve. Keep staff informed.

Staff manage openings. Clients use a personal offer page with exact details and a deadline.

## 1 Add an opening

Staff enter the appointment details, reply window (default 15 minutes), and any practical cutoff.

## 2 Find a match

Match service, availability and stylist. Exclude opt-outs. Offer the oldest eligible request first.

## 3 Client responds

Clients accept, decline or ask a question on their offer page. Decline or the reply deadline moves to the next client.

## 4 Confirm one holder

A clear, valid acceptance reserves the slot here. Staff update Square manually, then mark the checklist done.

Open the detail page for the holder and message timeline. Fast-forward 15 minutes to demonstrate no reply. Temporal preserves the clock and deadlines after restart.

VERIFICATION AND PROTOTYPE BOUNDARIES

# Checked behavior. Clearly stated limits.

37 automated tests passed, plus 17 browser checks across staff and client pages.

## What passed

**Staff:** protected access, message history and a manual Square checklist.

**Clients:** personal links show exact details, response choices and the result.

**Reliability:** duplicate protection, matching, timeouts, cancellation races, one holder and worker restart.

## What is simulated or excluded

**No real SMS.** Open the client's personal link from the staff demo. The client page is clearly simulated.

**No Square connection.** Staff update it manually.

**Sample waitlist.** Live intake and opt-out management remain future work. Staff passwords are local.

A PRACTICAL NEXT STEP

# Walk through a real cancellation together.

Lena and Carla can review the local prototype before any real-client pilot.

## A focused staff review

1. Pick an opening and explain who should get it first.
2. Try a question, decline, acceptance and cancellation; check the visible result and Square handoff.
3. Agree on practical cutoff guidance and what staff need before using it with real clients.

## Then prepare a small pilot

Add live waitlist consent/opt-out handling and SMS with safe retries.  
Review staff account support before a pilot.

Measure openings filled, staff checking time and conflicting claims against today's process.